

Registration problem: faced by students in private universities with open credit system.

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Abstract— This study explored the registration difficulties faced by private universities students that have adopted the open credit system, with a specific focus on students from the American International University-Bangladesh (AIUB). Despite the system's extensive integration, students continued to face challenges in achieving a smooth registration process. The research explained how the open credit system worked and examined some common problems associated with it. Data were collected through a mixed-method approach using Google Forms, where respondents shared their experiences with the registration process. The most frequently reported problems included system malfunctions, limited availability of relevant courses, and insufficient support services. The findings highlighted significant inefficiencies, resulting in low levels of student satisfaction. Simplifying registration platforms, improving technical support, and ensuring clear communication can help reduce these issues. Addressing these challenges is essential to enhancing students academic experiences, and further research is recommended to support the sustainability of the open credit system in private universities.

Keywords: Private universities, open credit system, registration, quantitative method, challenges.

I. INTRODUCTION

Smooth registration processes help ensure trouble-free academic operations at higher education institutions. Students in fixed-credit private universities of Bangladesh face immense difficulties at the time of registration. These problems include complex registration platforms, inadequate technical support, and ineffective communication channels. These issues disrupt students' academic planning and further administrative burdens. Fully addressing these challenges becomes critical to enhancing academic experiences and overall satisfaction among students. This paper identifies the major factors causing registration problems in fixed-credit private universities and suggests some actionable solutions that can be taken to improve the process.

II. METHODOLOGY

A. Research Design

To investigate the challenges associated with course registration in private universities using the open credit system, this study applied a mixed-method research design. This approach combined both quantitative and qualitative data to provide a well-rounded understanding of the registration process. The American International University–Bangladesh (AIUB) served as the primary case for data collection, as it actively operates under the open credit system.

B. Data Collection Procedure

The data were gathered through a structured online survey designed using Google Forms. The questionnaire included both close-ended and open-ended questions to ensure a balanced collection of statistical data and personal insights. The close-ended items addressed specific issues such as administrative flexibility, technical performance of the registration system, and availability of courses. Open-ended questions allowed respondents to share their personal experiences and suggestions.

The survey was shared with undergraduate students from various academic years and departments at AIUB. A total of 25

responses were recorded during May 2025. All participants were actively enrolled students familiar with the university's course registration process.

C. Data Analysis

The responses collected were exported into Microsoft Excel for analysis. Descriptive statistics, including frequency and percentage distributions, were used to summarize the results. Google Forms also generated visual representations of the data, such as pie charts and bar graphs, which were used to illustrate response trends. For example:

- Most students reported registering for 12–14 credit hours per semester.
- A significant portion of the respondents experienced technical issues during registration, particularly during peak hours.
- Many expressed dissatisfactions with the availability of seats on high-demand courses.
- A majority supported the introduction of a pre-registration system to improve course planning and reduce registration pressure.

The open-ended responses were reviewed manually to identify recurring themes. Comments frequently highlighted issues such as system slowdowns, limited administrative support during registration periods, and lack of clear course guidelines. These qualitative insights complemented the numerical data by providing context and practical examples of the difficulties faced by students.

D. Participant Selection

The participants in this study were selected based on their enrollment status at AIUB. The sample represented a range of academic years and programs to ensure a comprehensive view of the registration challenges under the open credit system. The responses reflected a variety of academic experiences, contributing to a more accurate assessment of the registration system's strengths and limitations.

III. RESULT AND DISCUSSION

A. Analytical Result:

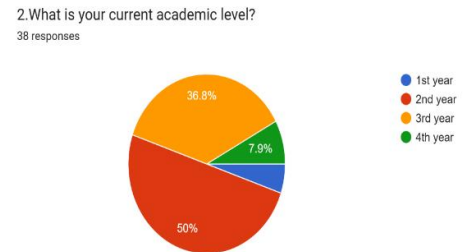


Figure 1: This figure shows the distribution of respondents by their academic level. It can be observed that half of the students surveyed are currently in their second year, while a significant portion (around 36.8%) are in their third year. This indicates that the majority of the responses are from students who are already well-engaged with the course registration system.

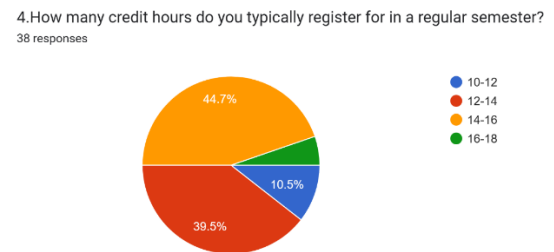


Figure 2: This figure illustrates the typical number of credit hours students register for each regular semester. The data reveals that a large number of students (44.7%) take between 14 to 16 credit hours, which is a common course load under the open credit system. Another notable portion registers for 12 to 14 credits, reflecting a moderate academic load.

6. How Would you rate your overall Registration experience?
39 responses

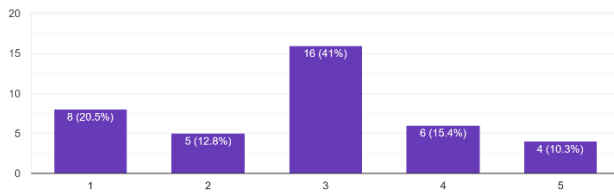


Figure 3: This figure presents the students' overall experience with the registration process. The majority of students rated their experience as average (41%), while a combined 51.2% rated it as below average (ratings 1 and 2). Only a small percentage (10.3%) expressed high satisfaction, indicating that there is considerable room for improvement in the current system.

7. The online registration System Often experiences technical glitches during peak times?
39 responses

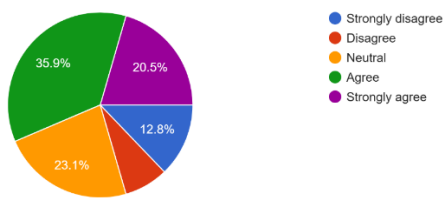


Figure 4: This figure shows students' feedback on whether the online registration system experiences technical glitches during peak times. A large portion of students (35.9%) agreed with this issue, while another 12.8% strongly disagreed. This highlights a recurring technical problem that affects the efficiency and fairness of the registration process.

13. The registration system is capable of handling the high number of students registering simultaneously.
39 responses

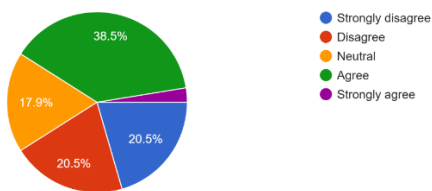


Figure 5: This figure shows that many students disagree with the notion that the current registration system can handle the high volume of simultaneous users. Around 38.5% agreed with the statement, and another 20.5% strongly disagreed. This supports the view that the current infrastructure is insufficient to manage peak-time demands.

16. An Unbalanced course load often negatively affects results.
38 responses

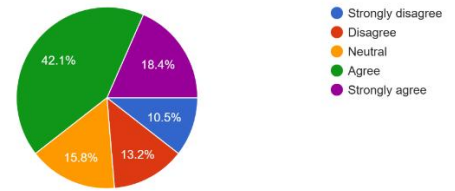


Figure 6: This figure explores whether an unbalanced course load negatively affects academic performance. A majority of students agreed (42.1%) or strongly agreed (18.4%) with the statement, showing that registration issues can have a direct academic impact, especially when students are forced to register for uneven or overly heavy course loads due to system flaws.

20. A pre - registration survey to access course demand would improve the process.
38 responses

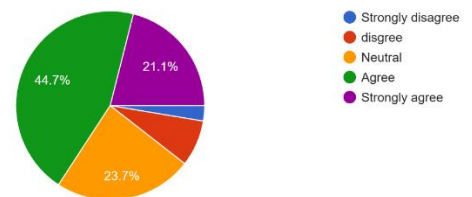


Figure 7: This figure presents students' views on the value of conducting a pre-registration survey to assess course demand. A large majority (44.7%) agreed, and 21.1% strongly agreed that this could help improve the registration process. Very few students disagreed, suggesting strong support for this preventive solution.

B. Discussion:

From the data in the result section, it can be said that most students at AIUB have faced issues with the current registration system. As shown in Figure 1, the majority of respondents are second- and third-year students, who are actively involved in the registration process.

According to Figure 3, over half of the students rated their registration experience as

average or below, which indicates dissatisfaction. It can be seen from Figure 4 that many students believe the system often faces technical issues during peak hours.

Figure 5 shows that most students feel the system cannot handle high traffic, which supports the need for infrastructure improvement. In Figure 6, many students agree that unbalanced course loads—often caused by registration problems—negatively affect their results.

Lastly, Figure 7 indicates that most students support the idea of a pre-registration survey to help improve the process.

By analyzing these charts, it can be clearly seen that most students are not satisfied with the current system. If improvements are made, the registration process will likely become more efficient and student-friendly.

IV. CONCLUSION

To conclude this study, the findings from 39 surveyed students at the American International University–Bangladesh (AIUB) reveal that course registration under the open credit system remains a significant challenge. Despite its intended flexibility, students frequently encounter issues such as technical glitches, course unavailability, and limited support during the registration period. These difficulties often result in disrupted academic planning, unbalanced course loads, and overall dissatisfaction with the process.

Addressing these problems requires a combination of strategic and technical improvements. Pre-registration surveys can help the university better understand student demand in advance, reducing pressure during registration. In parallel, upgrading the system infrastructure and ensuring real-time technical support would help minimize downtime and access issues. Furthermore, academic advising and clearer communication can guide students more effectively through the process. Collectively, these measures can significantly enhance the efficiency and fairness of course registration and contribute to improved academic outcomes.

A. Limitation

This study has a few limitations. The data was collected from a single institution—AIUB—and limited to 39

students from one registration cycle. As such, the results may not fully capture the broader experiences of students from other private universities in Bangladesh or reflect patterns across multiple semesters.

Additionally, the survey was conducted solely through Google Forms, without the inclusion of qualitative interviews or input from administrative or IT staff, which may have offered deeper insights into the systemic challenges.

B. Suggestions

Based on student feedback, several improvements are recommended. The introduction of a pre-registration system is highly encouraged to gauge course demand and plan accordingly. Enhancing the technical capacity of the registration platform to handle peak traffic, along with timely IT support, would reduce system failures. Clearer communication regarding timelines and policies, along with stronger academic advising, can help students make informed decisions. Lastly, flexible scheduling options and greater availability of core courses would provide students with more control and reduce stress during registration.

V. REFERENCES

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